

The effect of the *Extreme Couponing* television program is widespread. When I do coupon workshops, I always begin my presentation by asking how many in the room have seen the program. After a show of hands, I ask how many want to shop like that. I am sure I disappoint a few in the room when I tell them it is virtually impossible to replicate those kinds of trips here in Iowa.

Would the participants in the reality show be the only image of extreme couponers this book's readers knew? Was this the image they would be familiar with: people who stockpiled three thousand rolls of toilet paper and fifteen hundred deodorants, outrageous amounts that they couldn't possibly use in their own lifetime? What grocery store manager would actually allow a customer to empty their shelves, fill nine grocery carts, and use nine hundred coupons in a single transaction, and still be smiling about it? None of the stores I shop at even stock those amounts of products.

And where was the coverage about the huge donations Nathan Engles regularly makes to a local church food bank? Or the information that Diemer teaches others to coupon through her book, *Pick Another Checkout Lane*, Honey and her website, [www.KrazyCouponLady.com](http://www.KrazyCouponLady.com)? Reality shows aren't most people's reality, but would the average television viewer know that? Was this how the majority of Americans would view extreme couponers?

During the months I conducted research and wrote this book, one of my sisters, briefly unemployed, joined the ranks of extreme couponers, netting me a cohort in the hunt for good deals. Then in November of 2010, a local Pamida store experimented with tripling coupons, allowing me the